



KAIMOSI FRIENDS UNIVERSITY
Spring of Knowledge

PRELIMINARY TRAINING MANUAL

Digital Systems User Guide

CMS Administration | Staff Account Updater Portal

PART A

CMS Administration

PART B

Staff Portal

ICT Directorate | Version 1.0 | June 2026

Table of Contents

INTRODUCTION

- 1. System Overview & Who Uses What
- 2. System URLs & Access Requirements
- 3. User Roles & Permissions

PART A — CMS ADMINISTRATION

- 4. Logging In to the CMS
- 5. Dashboard Overview
- 6. Content Library
- 7. Content Workflow & Statuses
- 8. Content Editor
- 9. Review Queue
- 10. Media Library
- 11. Research Office Module
- 12. International Office Module
- 13. Institutional Repository
- 14. Academic Profiles & Staff Management
- 15. Governance Module
- 16. Academic Structure
- 17. Admissions Management
- 18. Site Controls
- 19. Navigation Manager
- 20. Redirects
- 21. Content Health

2
2. Workflow Console

2
3. User Management

2
4. Taxonomy Manager

2
5. Audit Log

2
6. Settings & Branding

PART B — STAFF PORTAL

2
7. Getting Access & First Login

2
8. Onboarding Steps

2
9. Profile Editor Sections

3
0. Submitting Your Profile for Review

3
1. Understanding Review Status

3
2. Reviewer: Approving & Returning Submissions

APPENDIX

A. Quick-Reference Tips & Best Practices

B. Support Contacts

1. System Overview

Kaimosi Friends University operates three integrated digital systems that together power the official university website at www.kafu.ac.ke.

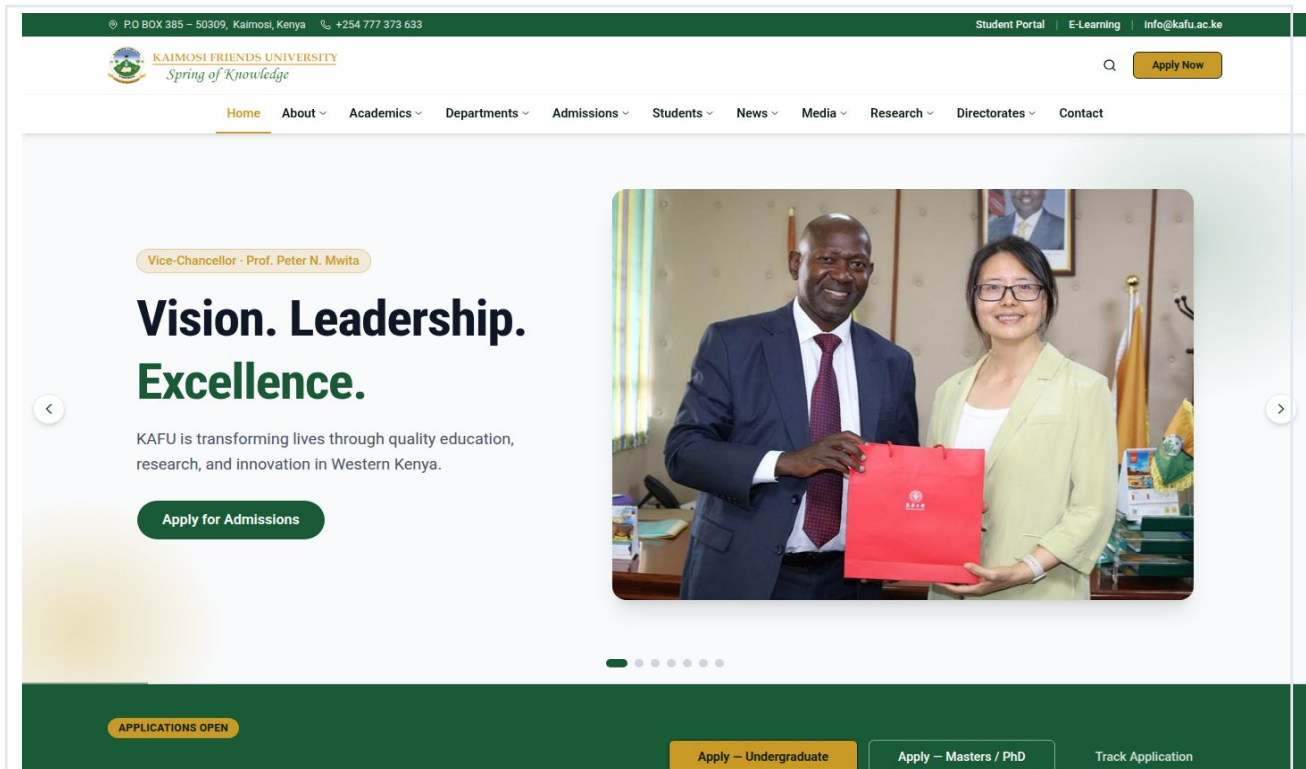


Figure 1.1 — The KAFU public website. All content displayed here is managed through the CMS Administration system.

System	Who Uses It	Purpose
CMS Administration	Communications, ICT, Reviewers, Admins	Create, edit, approve and publish all website content — news, events, programmes, research, staff profiles, and site configuration.
Staff Account Updater Portal	All academic and administrative staff	Update personal academic profile information for display on the university website.
KAFU Website (Public)	General public, students, staff	The live website. Displays all approved and published content. No editing happens here.

2. System URLs & Access Requirements

System	URL	Access
KAFU Website	www.kafu.ac.ke	Public — no login required

System	URL	Access
CMS Administration	cms.kafu.ac.ke	Authorised staff — contact ICT (ict@kafu.ac.ke)
Staff Portal	portal-update.kafu.ac.ke	All permanent & contract staff — contact ICT

3. User Roles & Permissions

Role	Label	What They Can Do
Super Admin	super_admin	Full access to everything — all content, all settings, user management, site configuration. Typically 1–2 people in ICT.
ICT Admin	ict_admin	Same as Super Admin. Handles technical configuration, site controls, user accounts, and all content modules.
Communications Admin	communications_admin	Creates and edits all content. Manages media, news, events, research. Cannot access system settings or user management.
Reviewer	reviewer	Reviews submitted content in the Review Queue. Can approve or request revisions. Cannot create content or change settings.

CMS Administration Manual

For authorised staff creating and managing university website content.

4. Logging In to the CMS

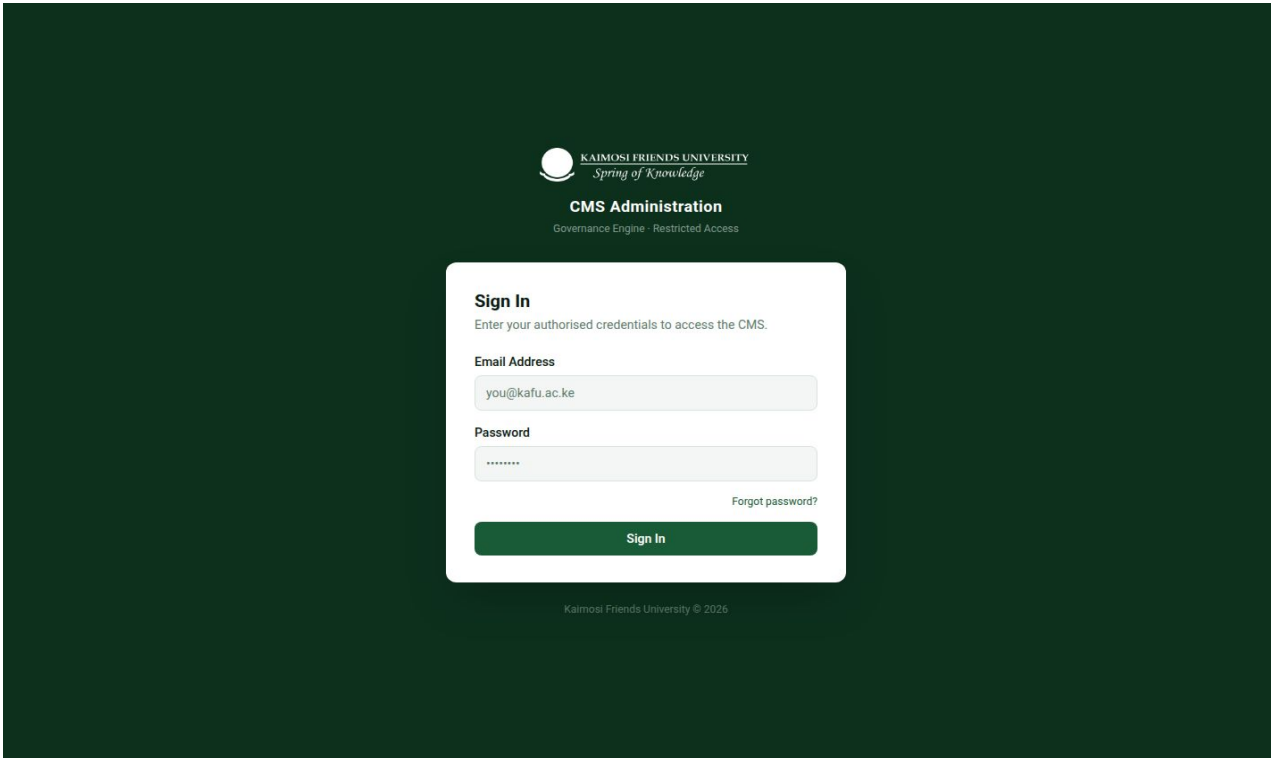


Figure 4.1 — CMS Administration login screen at cms.kafu.ac.ke

1 Navigate to the CMS URL

Open your browser and go to cms.kafu.ac.ke. You will see the CMS Administration sign-in page with the KAFU logo.

2 Enter your institutional email

Type your KAFU email address in the format you@kafu.ac.ke. This is the same email registered with ICT when your account was created.

3 Enter your password

Type your password. If you have forgotten it, click "Forgot password?" to receive a reset link by email.

4 Click Sign In

You will be taken to the Dashboard. The sidebar on the left shows your available modules based on your role.

TIP

TIP — If you see "Invalid credentials", double-check that Caps Lock is not on. If the problem persists, ask an Admin to reset your password via User Management.

5. Dashboard Overview

After logging in, the Dashboard provides an at-a-glance view of the CMS health and pending work. It contains four key widgets:

Widget	What It Shows
Content Health	A ring-gauge score (0–100) indicating overall website content quality. Below it are alerts for stale, expired, or overdue content items.
Workflow Pipeline	A count of content items at each workflow stage: Draft, Submitted, Under Review, Approved, Scheduled, Published.
Site Operations	Quick-action buttons for the most common tasks: New Content, View Published, Manage Media, Review Queue, Navigation Manager, Redirects.
Recent Activity	A log of the latest content changes across the system — who edited what and when.

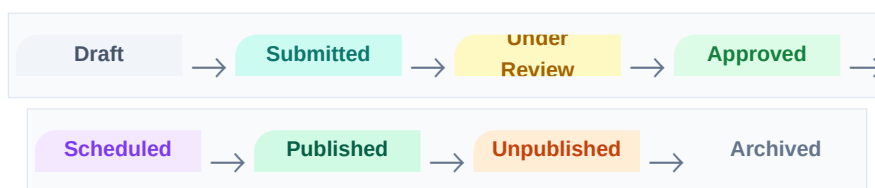
6. Content Library

The Content Library is the central list of all website content items. Access it from the sidebar under **Content**. Use the filter bar at the top to narrow by Type, Status, or keyword search.

Column	Meaning
Title	The name of the content item. Click to open the editor.
Type	The content category (News, Event, Announcement, Opportunity, Programme, Staff Profile, Page, Document).
Status	Current workflow stage — see Section 7 for full explanation.
Author	Who created the item.
Modified	When it was last edited.
Actions	Edit, Preview, Publish, Archive buttons.

7. Content Workflow & Statuses

Every piece of content goes through a defined lifecycle before appearing on the public website. Understanding these stages is essential for all CMS users.



Status	What It Means	Who Acts Next
Draft	Content is being written. Not visible to public.	Author — continues editing, then submits
Submitted	Author has marked it ready for review.	Reviewer — moves to Under Review
Under Review	A Reviewer is actively checking the content.	Reviewer — Approves or Requests Revision
Approved	Ready to go live. Admin can publish immediately or schedule.	Admin — publishes or schedules
Scheduled	Set to publish automatically on a future date and time.	System — auto-publishes at set time
Published	Visible to the public on www.kafu.ac.ke .	Admin — can unpublish or archive
Unpublished	Temporarily removed from public view. Content is preserved.	Admin — can re-publish or archive
Archived	Permanently removed from the website. Still stored in CMS for records.	Admin only

8. Content Editor

The Content Editor opens when you click an item in the Content Library or click **New Content**. Key panels:

Panel / Field	Description
Title	The heading displayed on the website.
Slug	Auto-generated URL-friendly identifier. Edit only if needed.
Type	Content category — determines where content appears on the website.
Body	The main text. Supports rich-text formatting.
Featured Image	Thumbnail image selected from the Media Library.

Panel / Field	Description
Summary / Excerpt	Short description shown in listing pages (max ~200 characters).
Published At	Set a date/time for automatic publishing. Leave blank to publish immediately.
Expiry Date	After this date, content is flagged as expired on the Content Health dashboard.
SEO Title	Title shown in search engine results. Defaults to main Title if blank.
Meta Description	Short summary for search results. Aim for 120–160 characters.
Revision History	Every save creates a revision. You can restore any previous version.

TIP

BEST PRACTICE — Always click "Save Draft" frequently while writing. Only click "Submit for Review" when the content is fully complete. Once submitted, the author cannot edit until a Reviewer returns it.

9. Review Queue

The Review Queue collects all content items with status Submitted or Under Review. Available to all CMS roles. Items are listed oldest-first so nothing is forgotten.

1

Open the Review Queue

Click Review Queue in the left sidebar.

2

Claim an item

Click "Start Review" on any Submitted item. Its status changes to Under Review.

3

Read the content carefully

Check accuracy, grammar, policy compliance, appropriate imagery, and SEO quality. Use Preview to see the live appearance.

4

Approve or Request Revision

Click Approve to move to Approved status. Click "Request Revision", enter feedback, and the author is notified.

10. Media Library

Stores all images, PDFs, and documents. Drag-and-drop upload. All media is reusable across content items.

Type	Recommended Size	Max File Size
Hero / Banner images	1920 × 800 px	2 MB
News / Event thumbnails	1200 × 630 px	1 MB
Staff profile photos	400 × 400 px (square)	500 KB

Type	Recommended Size	Max File Size
Gallery photos	1600 × 1200 px	3 MB
Documents (PDF)	—	20 MB

11. Research Office Module

Manages research information at /research: Themes, Projects, Publications, Grants, Partners. All items have full CRUD via the CMS sidebar under Research Office.

12. International Office Module

Manages /international: Partnerships and Exchange Programmes. Access via International Office in sidebar.

13. Institutional Repository

Stores academic theses, dissertations, and reports. All Records view + Pending Review queue for items awaiting approval.

14. Academic Profiles & Staff Management

Staff Profiles editor, Staff Content shortcut, Submission Review queue (staff portal submissions), and Staff Accounts management. All under Academic Profiles in sidebar.

15. Governance Module

Manages University Council, VC Office, Management Board, Directorates, Departments, Strategic Plan, Policies & Regulations, Service Charter. Admin-only access.

16. Academic Structure

Schools & Faculties and Programmes catalogue. Add or edit the five schools (SESS, SBE, SCIT, SOS, SHS) and all 38+ degree programmes.

17. Admissions Management

Document Uploads, Fees & Payments tables, Postgraduate Programmes information, Eligibility Settings (minimum requirements per programme category).

18. Site Controls

Homepage Manager, Emergency Banner (site-wide urgent notices), Announcement Bar (scrolling ticker), Maintenance Mode, Social Media Links, Footer Text.

19. Navigation Manager

Controls all website menus in real time. Three tabs: Primary Navigation (mega-menu editor), Utility Navigation (top bar links), Footer Navigation (link columns). Changes take effect immediately on save.

20. Redirects

Create URL redirect rules (301 permanent / 302 temporary). Set source path, destination URL, and active toggle. Use 301 for renamed pages to preserve search rankings.

21. Content Health

Health score (0–100) with issue cards for: missing SEO descriptions, missing images, stale content (6+ months not updated), and expired content. Review monthly; aim for score above 75.

22. Workflow Console

Unified view of ALL content items at every workflow stage. Useful for identifying content stuck in any stage and for bulk management.

23. User Management

Create, edit, deactivate CMS accounts. Admin-only. Set role (Super Admin, ICT Admin, Communications Admin, Reviewer). New users receive a temporary password they change on first login.

24. Taxonomy Manager

Controls tags and categories for classifying content. Add/edit/delete terms for School, Programme Level, Research Theme, News Category, Event Type.

25. Audit Log

Records every action in the CMS — who did what and when. Use to investigate accidental deletions or monitor user activity for governance. Admin-only.

26. Settings & Branding

Site Name, Logo, Favicon, Brand Colours, Contact Email. Also contains the Permissions Matrix for fine-grained role-action control. Admin-only.

Staff Account Updater Portal

For all KAFU academic and administrative staff managing their academic profiles.

27. Getting Access & First Login

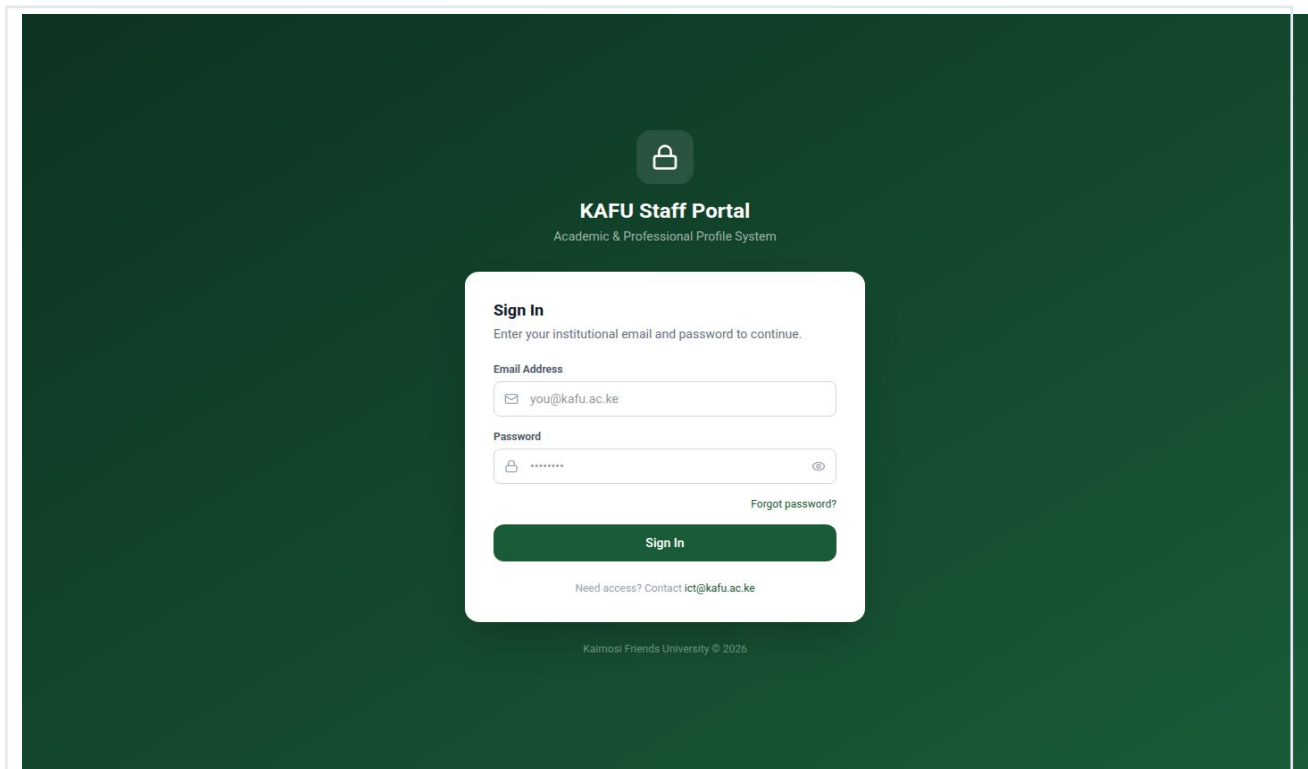


Figure 27.1 — Staff Account Updater Portal login screen

- 1 Contact ICT**
Email ict@kafu.ac.ke with your full name, staff ID, department, and institutional email address.
- 2 Receive your credentials**
ICT will create your account and send you a temporary password by email.
- 3 Log in**
Go to the Staff Portal URL, enter your institutional email and the temporary password, then follow the onboarding steps.

28. Onboarding Steps (First-Time Login)

Two mandatory steps must be completed before accessing your profile:

- 1 Change Password**
Replace your temporary password with a secure personal password (minimum 8 characters).
- 2 Accept Data Policy**
Read and accept the University's data processing policy (v1.0). Required by Kenya's Data Protection Act 2019.
- 3 Start Editing**
You are taken to your Profile Editor dashboard.

NOTE

You cannot skip the onboarding steps. Both the password change and policy acceptance are mandatory.

29. Profile Editor Sections

The Profile Editor has **seven tabs**. Fill in each tab and click **Save Section** before moving to the next. A completeness percentage is shown for each section. The system requires minimum overall completeness before submission.

Tab 1 — Personal

Full Name, Title, Designation, Department, School, Profile Photo (square headshot), Academic Identifiers (ORCID, Google Scholar, Scopus).

Tab 2 — Biography

Short Biography (max 300 characters for event introductions), Full Biography (300–600 words, third person), Research Interests (comma-separated).

Tab 3 — Qualifications

Academic degrees and professional certifications. Add as many as you have — Degree, Institution, Year Awarded.

Tab 4 — Teaching

Courses currently taught: Course Name, Course Code, Programme/Level, Semester.

Tab 5 — Research

Publications (journal articles, books, conference papers), Ongoing Projects, Grants, and PhD/MSc Student Supervision.

Tab 6 — Contact

Office Location, Office Phone, Institutional Email (pre-filled), Alternate Email, Office Hours (consultation availability).

Tab 7 — Uploads

CV (PDF — used for CV pre-fill feature), Certificate Copies (internal verification), Other Documents.

TIP

TIP — After uploading your CV (PDF), click "Pre-fill from CV". The system extracts qualifications, publications, and bio automatically. Review each suggestion carefully before accepting.

30. Submitting Your Profile for Review

1

Check completeness

Review the completeness indicators at the top. All sections should be at least partially complete.

2

Save all sections

Make sure you clicked "Save Section" in every tab. Unsaved changes are not included in the submission.

3

Click Submit for Review

A confirmation dialogue appears with a consent statement.

4

Confirm submission

Click "Confirm & Submit". Status changes to Submitted and the CMS Review Team is notified.

NOTE

You cannot edit your profile while it is under review. Wait for reviewer feedback.

31. Understanding Your Review Status

Status	What It Means	What You Should Do
Draft	Still editing. Not submitted.	Continue filling in sections, then submit when ready.
Submitted	Sent to review team. Awaiting assignment.	Wait. Review processed within 3–5 working days.
Under Review	Reviewer is actively checking your submission.	Wait. You may be contacted by email for quick questions.
Revision Requested	Reviewer found issues and returned submission with feedback.	Read reviewer notes. Make changes and resubmit.
Approved	Profile approved. Will be published to the website shortly.	No action needed. Profile live within 24 hours.

32. Reviewer: Approving & Returning Submissions

Staff profile submissions appear in the CMS under **Academic Profiles** → **Submission Review**.

1**Open Submission Review queue**

Navigate to Academic Profiles → Submission Review. Listed by staff member, submission date, and department.

2**Open a submission**

Side-by-side comparison: current live profile (left) vs proposed changes (right). Changes are highlighted.

3**Review each section**

Check: factual accuracy, professional tone, appropriate profile photo, valid URLs, no personal contact details outside the Contact section.

4**Approve or Request Revision**

Approve: profile published to website. Request Revision: enter specific feedback notes and click "Send Back". Staff member is notified.

WARNING

PRIVACY — Do not approve profiles containing personal information not explicitly consented for public display (e.g. personal home address or mobile number). Only institutional contacts are appropriate.

A. Quick-Reference Tips & Best Practices

CMS Writing

- News titles should be specific: "KAFU Launches New MSc Data Science Programme" — not "New Programme".
- Always add a featured image to news and event items.
- Write meta descriptions for every published page (140–160 characters).
- Set expiry dates on time-sensitive content so Content Health flags them after they pass.

CMS Workflow

- The Review Queue should never have items sitting for more than 5 working days.
- Do not publish directly from Draft — always go through the review workflow.
- Use the Workflow Console weekly to identify items stuck at any stage.

Staff Portal

- Profile photo: clear professional headshot, square, plain background, minimum 400×400px.
- Write your Full Biography in third person: "Dr. Wanjiku is a specialist in..." not "I am..."
- Add your ORCID iD — it links your profile to your full publication record automatically.
- Update your profile at least once a year or when you gain a new qualification.

B. Support Contacts

Issue	Contact	How
Cannot log in / forgotten password	ICT Directorate	ict@kafu.ac.ke or visit ICT offices at SCIT Block
New user account request	ICT Directorate	Email ict@kafu.ac.ke with staff details and required role
Content corrections on live website	Communications Office	communications@kafu.ac.ke
Incorrect information on staff profile	Human Resources	hr@kafu.ac.ke — include staff name and specific error
Technical errors or system crashes	ICT Directorate	ict@kafu.ac.ke with screenshot of error message